Accessibility & Testing

Deep Dive into Accessibility & Testing

- What is Accessibility in UI/UX?
- Key Accessibility Principles
- Common Accessibility Features
- Accessibility in Figma
- What is Usability Testing?
- Tools for Testing
- Key Takeaways

Accessibility & Testing in UI/UX Design

Making products usable for everyone & testing to improve experience

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ACCESSIBILITY

What is Accessibility in UI/UX?

What is Accessibility in UI/UX?

Accessibility means designing for everyone, including people with visual, hearing, motor, or cognitive disabilities.

Why it matters:

- Ethical and inclusive
- Often a legal requirement
- Improves overall usability

Example

Visual Idea: A UI being used by different types of users – screen reader, keyboard only, etc.

Visual

- Colorblind
- Low vision
- Blind

Hearing

- Hard of hearing
- Deaf

Cognitive

- Learning disabilities
- Autism
- Seizure

Speech

- Speech impediment
- Unable to speak

Mobility

- Arthritis
- Quadriplegia
- Spinal cord injury

Neural

- Bipolar
- Anxiety
- PTSD
- OCD
- Depression

Key Accessibility Principles

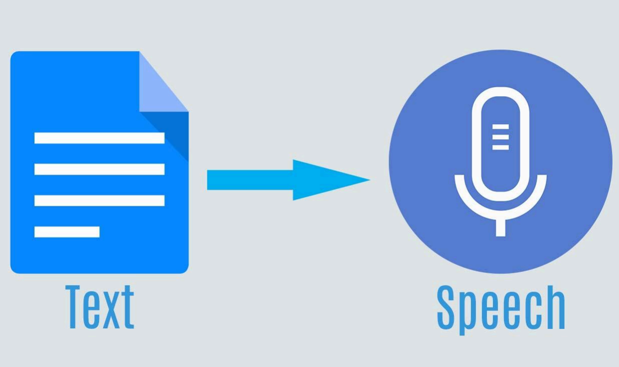
Key Accessibility Principles

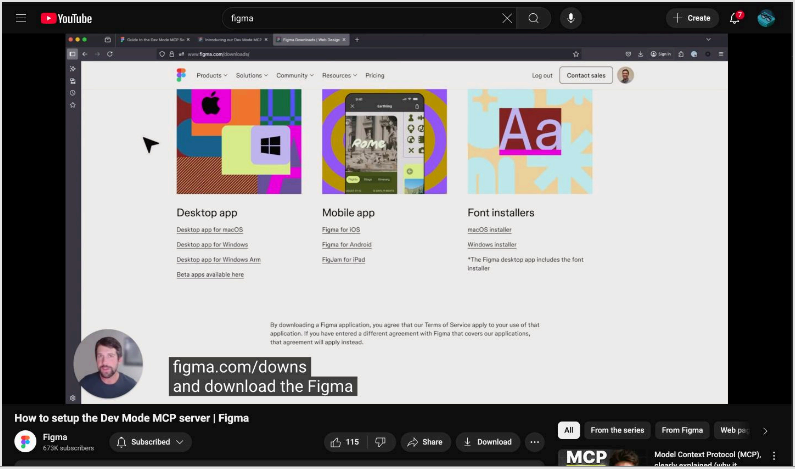
1. Perceivable – Content must be easy to see or hear
2. Operable – UI must work with keyboard, not just mouse
3. Understandable – Language and layout should be clear
4. Robust – Compatible with assistive tech (e.g., screen readers)

Common Accessibility Features

Common Accessibility Features

- Sufficient color contrast
- Alt text for images
- Keyboard navigation
- Labels for forms
- Responsive typography


Text
Speech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Desktop app

- Desktop app for macOS
- Desktop app for Windows
- Desktop app for Windows Arm
- Beta apps available here

Mobile app

- Figma for iOS
- Figma for Android
- FigJam for iPad

Font installers

- macOS installer
- Windows installer

*The Figma desktop app includes the font installer

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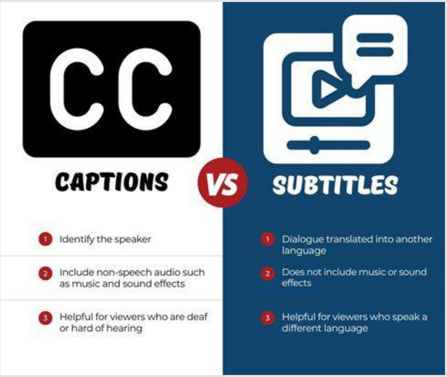

CC
CAPTIONS
VS
SUBTITLES

CAPTIONS	SUBTITLES
1 Identify the speaker	1 Dialogue translated into another language
2 Include non-speech audio such as music and sound effects	2 Does not include music or sound effects
3 Helpful for viewers who are deaf or hard of hearing	3 Helpful for viewers who speak a different language

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Accessibility in Figma

Accessibility in Figma

- Contrast plugin – to check text/background color
- Focus Order plugin – simulate keyboard navigation
- Content Order – helpful for screen readers

What is Usability Testing?

What is Usability Testing?

Usability testing means watching real users try your design to find issues.

Goal:

- Discover confusing areas
- Understand user behavior
- Improve task success rate

Types of Usability Testing

Types of Usability Testing

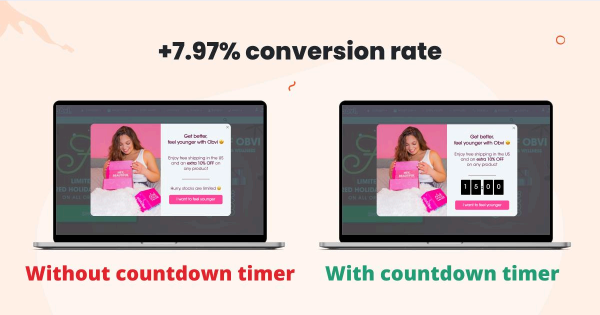
- A/B Testing
- Guerilla Testing (quick feedback from random users)

What is A/B Testing?

A/B Testing is a method where you compare two versions of a design (Version A vs Version B) to see which one performs better.

How it works:

- Create two versions (e.g., different button color or layout).
- Show each version to a separate group of users.
- Measure which version gets more clicks, signups, or conversions.

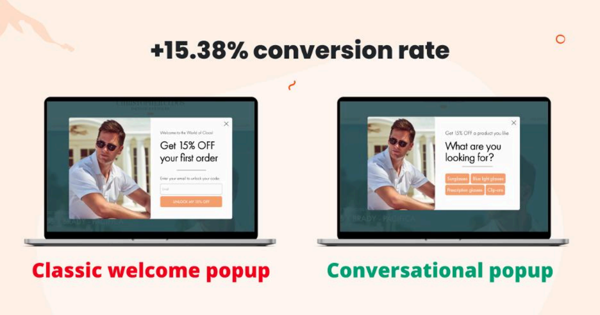


+7.97% conversion rate

Get better,
feel younger with Obvi
Enjoy free shipping in the US and an extra 10% OFF on any product
Hurry, stocks are limited
I want to feel younger
Get better,
feel younger with Obvi
Enjoy free shipping in the US and an extra 10% OFF on any product
15:00
I want to feel younger

Without countdown timer

With countdown timer



+15.38% conversion rate

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Enter your email to unlock your code:
Email
UNLOCK MY 15% OFF
Get 15% OFF a product you like
What are you looking for?
Sunglasses
Blue light glasses
Prescription glasses
Clip-ons

Classic welcome popup

Conversational popup

What is Guerrilla Testing?

Guerrilla testing is a quick and informal usability test — usually done in public spaces (like cafes or colleges) with random people.

How it works:

- Approach someone and ask them to try your design.
- Give them a simple task (e.g., "Can you find the checkout button?").
- Observe where they struggle or succeed.

A/B vs Guerrilla Testing

A/B vs Guerrilla Testing

- **A/B Testing** is like a science experiment → you change one variable and measure the result.
- **Guerrilla Testing** is like asking strangers for directions to see if your map (design) makes sense.

What to Test?

What to Test?

- Can users complete a task easily?
- Do they get stuck?
- How is their emotional reaction?
- Can they navigate the UI?

Tip: Watch, don’t explain during testing.

Summary

Summary

- Accessibility improves usability for everyone
- Testing finds real issues before launch
- You don’t need many users to test
- Heuristics are a great starting tool
- Use tools like Maze, Lighthouse, Figma plugins

Task

Task

1. Pick any website or app.
2. Check if it's accessible (readable text, alt text, keyboard navigation).
3. Ask one friend to use the site and observe any confusion.
4. Write 3 issues and suggest improvements.